EXECUTIVE MARKETING STRATEGY & BEHAVIORAL ANALYSIS

Converting Casual Riders into High-Value Members

Empirical insights from 4.58M rides in 2025 guiding targeted digital conversion campaigns

Marketing Analyst Team
Director of Marketing: Lily Moreno

Cyclistic Bike-Share Chicago • 2025/2026

The Core Business Task & Strategic Mandate

Business Objective

Maximize long-term revenue through annual membership conversions.

Financial Rationale

Finance analysts proved annual members are significantly more profitable.

Growth Strategy

Convert aware casual riders rather than acquisition of cold leads.

Primary Analytical Question: How do annual members and casual riders use Cyclistic bikes differently?

KEY STAKEHOLDER: LILY MORENO

Data Architecture, ROCCC & Privacy Compliance

Source Integrity

Direct monthly logs provided by Motivate International Inc. under open license.

ROCCC Validation

Verified as Reliable, Original, Comprehensive, Current (2025), and Cited.

Privacy & Security

Strict zero PII safeguards preventing credit card or personal ID tracking.

Fleet Scale

5,824 bicycles operating across 692 Chicago docking stations.

Annual Scope

12 continuous monthly datasets consolidating over 4.5M raw trips.

Technical Data Processing & Quality Audit

01

Deduplication

Zero duplicate ride IDs verified across all 12 ingested files.

02

Anomaly Filtering

Eliminated trips under 1 minute and system maintenance rides over 24h.

03

Feature Engineering

Calculated ride length in minutes and weekday names for behavioral analysis.

Data Pipeline Tools: Python (Pandas batch consolidation) • Excel openpyxl • Tableau Public Visualizations

2025 High-Level Ridership Overview

4.58M

Total Annual Cleaned Trips

Across entire Chicago metropolitan network

64.0%

Annual Member Ride Share

2,933,062 rides logged by committed commuters

1.98x

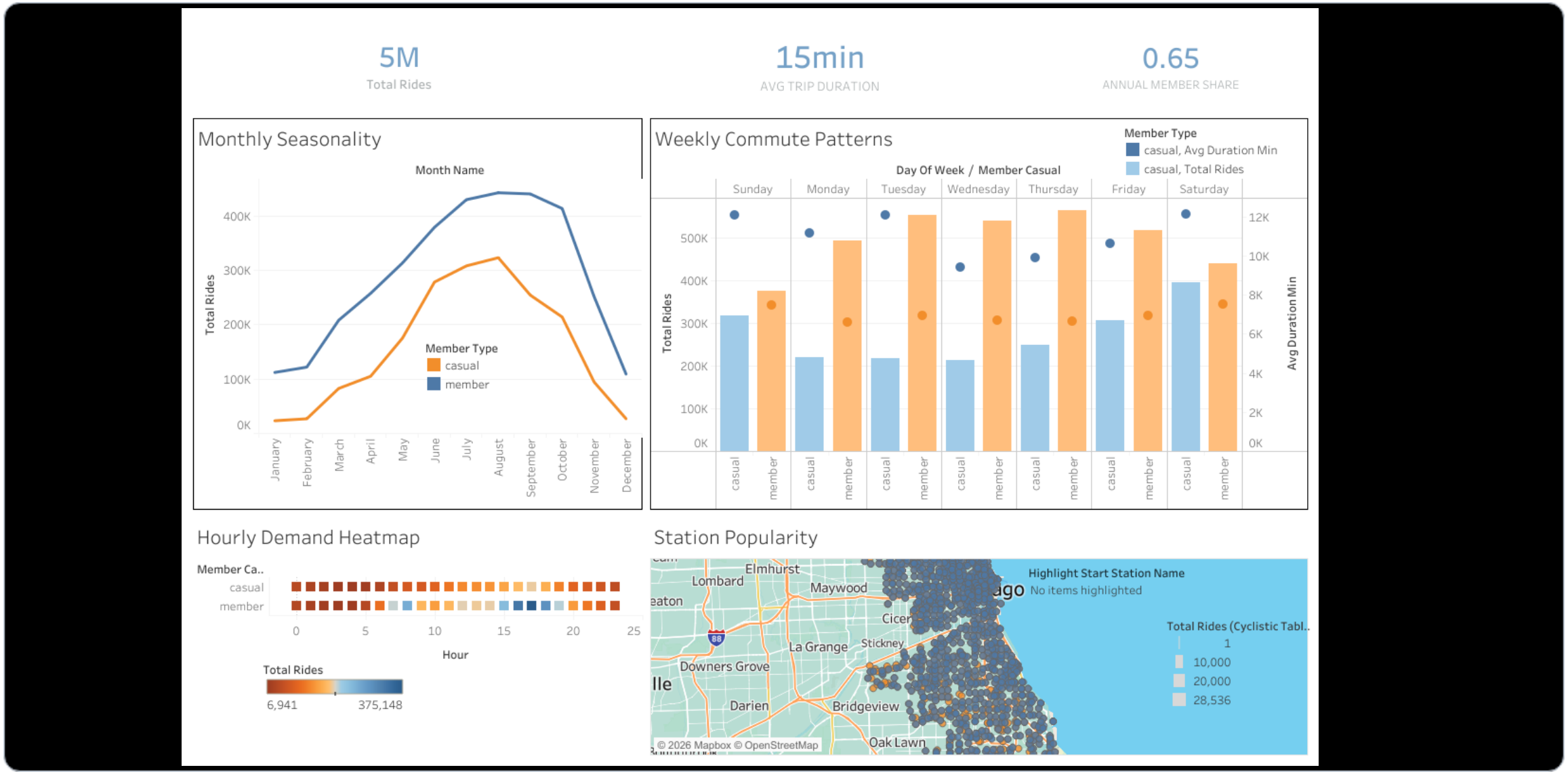
Casual / Member Duration Ratio

Casual rides avg 24.6 min vs 12.4 min for members

Key Strategic Takeaway: Casual riders represent 36.0% of ridership (1.65M trips) and spend twice as long per trip, representing substantial potential membership value.

Comprehensive Multi-Pane Tableau Dashboard

Source: cyclistic_tableau_aggregated.csv • cyclistic_tableau_stations.csv



Seasonality: Peak Summer vs. Year-Round Utility

Casual Rider Summer Surge

62.3% of annual casual rides happen between June and September alone.

Stable Commuter Baseline

Members maintain steady utilization across 9 to 10 months annually.

Winter Contraction

Casual usage plummets to 5.3% in winter while member transit continues.

STRATEGIC MARKETING WINDOW

May – Aug

All conversion ad spend and on-site promotions must deploy during these 4 high-exposure months.

Weekday Transit vs. Weekend Recreation

Annual Members

78.5% of all trips occur Monday through Friday.

Heatmap proves acute spikes at **8:00 AM and 5:00 PM**.

Consistent, direct commutes averaging **11.8 to 12.3 minutes**.

Casual Riders

44.8% of total volume concentrated on Saturday and Sunday.

Heatmap shows steady midday ramp from **12:00 PM to 4:00 PM**.

Weekend leisure duration peaks at **28.1 minutes**.

Strategic Synthesis: Casual users treat Cyclistic as entertainment, while members treat it as essential daily transit.

Spatial Corridors & Fleet Selection

Transit Hubs

Members cluster at commercial stations: Clinton & Washington, Kingsbury & Kinzie.

Waterfront Tourism

Casual rides anchor at Navy Pier, Lake Shore Drive, and Millennium Park.

Electric Adoption

Casual users choose electric bikes and scooters at 50.6% vs 40.5% for members.

Conversion Venue: Physical QR promotions should be localized precisely to coastal docking stations where casual riders initiate and end trips.

Top 3 Actionable Recommendations for Marketing

1

Seasonal Pass Tier

Launch a 4-month Summer Membership rolling over into annual plans.

2

Geo-Targeted Promos

Deploy digital in-app upgrade nudges at high-volume waterfront hubs.

3

Electric Fleet Perks

Offer free e-bike unlock minutes bundled into the annual membership pass.

Expected Impact: Lowers barrier to entry for leisure riders while locking in predictable annual recurring revenue.

Digital Media & Campaign Rollout Timeline

PHASE 1: MARCH – APRIL

Early Bird Trials

Launch email invitations offering 30-day spring trial passes.

PHASE 2: MAY – AUGUST

Geo-Targeted Push

Deploy weekend station QR codes and cost-comparison savings calculators.

PHASE 3: SEPTEMBER

End-of-Season Rollover

Credit summer single-ride fees directly toward full 2026 annual renewals.

KPI Tracking: Track conversion rate of single pass users, summer pass rollover percentage, and average customer lifetime value (LTV).

CYCLISTIC MARKETING ANALYTICS TEAM

Ready for Executive Sign-Off & Implementation

Converting aware casual riders into loyal members drives predictable, high-margin growth.

Questions & Discussion with Lily Moreno and Executive Leadership